CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 18

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- She makes more money from them.
- She prefers them to prescriptions.
- The man is unfamiliar with them.
- The man wants cheap eye drops.

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- He should consider visiting his doctor.
- He should try her brand of eye drops.
- He should wait for a few more days.
- He should get an eyeglass prescription.

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- It is difficult to find an eye doctor.
- He wants something immediately.
- His prescription is too expensive.
- They're better than prescription drops.

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- He has a new prescription.
- His eye drops are all gone.
- He wants to get advice.
- His eye dropper didn't work.

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- It's more expensive than at other pharmacies.
- He heard that the price was less.
- His health plan doesn't cover eye drops.
- It's more costly than his previous purchase.

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

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Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- He must apply the drops frequently.
- He worries about touching his eyes.
- The other drops had no instructions.
- The woman needed to be clearer.

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- She works at an eye doctor's office.
- She knows people benefit from instruction.
- He has been using it in a wrong way.
- The prescription is difficult to read.

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ a retail sales clerk
- ◯ a store manager
- ◯ a repair technician
- ◯ a customer service clerk

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ A favour was returned.
- ◯ A request was granted.
- ◯ An offer was considered.
- ◯ A complaint was registered.

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ to take out the sales receipt
- ◯ to see what the problem is
- ◯ to replace the ink cartridges
- ◯ to ensure nothing's missing

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ a merchandise exchange
- ◯ a full reimbursement
- ◯ an added discount
- ◯ a partial credit

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ checked the bill for mistakes
- ◯ taken additional costs into account
- ◯ requested more of a discount
- ◯ asked for a warranty

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ He has an unhealthy tree in his yard.
- ◯ He saw a tree fall down.
- ◯ He wants some tree branches removed.
- ◯ He wants several trees cut down.

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- ◯ The tree is in a difficult place.
- ◯ The tree is too tall and wide.
- ◯ The neighbour has an injury.
- ◯ He dislikes his neighbour.

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ that her company is used to small backyards
- ◯ that the power lines can be moved easily
- ◯ that the tree stump will be cut to grass level
- ◯ that the tree removal won't be too expensive

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ because wood chips from the tree are good for gardens
- ◯ because her company might get some garden work
- ◯ because the tree might destroy the surrounding gardens
- ◯ because they can plant flowers where the tree was

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ It makes his living room dark.
- ◯ It shades his whole house.
- ◯ It makes his backyard feel too small.
- ◯ It drops too many leaves on his grass.

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ An expert will visit the man's garden.
- ◯ An expert will cut down the tree this week.
- ◯ The man will book an appointment this week.
- ◯ The woman will discuss the tree with her experts.

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. Mackenzie found a book that _____
- ◯ was a rare German edition of a novel.
- ◯ was autographed by the author.
- ◯ he donated to the library.
- ◯ was very well known but rare.

2. Mackenzie found the book _____
- ◯ during a trip abroad.
- ◯ at a yard sale.
- ◯ on an internet site.
- ◯ at an antique book shop.

3. Mackenzie was surprised _____
- ◯ by the value of the book.
- ◯ by what he found in the book.
- ◯ that the book was available online.
- ◯ that the library did not have this book.

4. Mackenzie decided to _____
- ◯ give the book to the library.
- ◯ keep the book himself.
- ◯ sell the book online.
- ◯ buy the book from the antique dealer.

5. Mackenzie also plans to _____
- ◯ build a new library for his town.
- ◯ visit a book sale in Germany.
- ◯ read the book one more time.
- ◯ build a reading room in his house.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. What problem are the colleagues discussing?
- ◯ a new boss
- ◯ work hours
- ◯ a family issue
- ◯ overtime shifts

2. What type of store do they work in?
- ◯ a sports arena
- ◯ a department store
- ◯ a sporting goods retailer
- ◯ a ski and snowboard resort

3. Why does Gene, the older man, want a weekend off?
- ◯ to take a short trip
- ◯ to spend time with family
- ◯ to relax at home
- ◯ to go buy new skis

4. Why does the boss give Gene more weekend shifts?
- ◯ Only Gene is qualified to do the work.
- ◯ His colleagues can't do special orders.
- ◯ Gene has to order the ski equipment.
- ◯ Gene is the most experienced supervisor.

5. How does Jake, the younger man, feel about Gene working weekends?
- ◯ He thinks Gene needs time with his family.
- ◯ Gene's lifestyle makes it easier for him.
- ◯ He thinks Gene gets the quietest shifts.
- ◯ He would prefer to work weekends himself.

6. Why does the woman switch shifts with Gene?
- ◯ She enjoys working weekends.
- ◯ She owes Gene a favour.
- ◯ It's less busy on weekends.
- ◯ It helps both of them out.

PART 5

7. How will their boss likely feel about the switch?

- ◯ accepting
- ◯ discontent
- ◯ surprised
- ◯ irritated

8. How do the colleagues treat each other?

- ◯ They're considerate.
- ◯ They're argumentative.
- ◯ They're indifferent.
- ◯ They're unaccommodating.

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. The radio show is discussing green bins because _____

- ◯ the city's composting program is controversial.
- ◯ household garbage reduction is impossible.
- ◯ people are refusing to separate their garbage.
- ◯ they have been popular for many years.

2. Knightley uses the green bin because _____

- ◯ compost is a great material for her garden soil.
- ◯ she has garbage pickup every two weeks.
- ◯ she believes the program is a good initiative.
- ◯ her children enjoy learning about composting.

3. Beauregarde, the gardener, thinks _____

- ◯ backyard composters are better than green bins.
- ◯ composting with green bins is easier for people.
- ◯ learning to compost can be challenging for some.
- ◯ backyard composting is more costly than green bins.

4. Volkov, the councillor, believes the green bin program is _____

- ◯ a costly waste of taxpayer's money.
- ◯ an educational undertaking for residents.
- ◯ an efficient fix to the city's problem.
- ◯ an adequate way to tackle food waste.

5. Volkov and Beauregarde would agree that _____

- ◯ the green bin program creates something useful.
- ◯ chemical fertilizers are harmful to the environment.
- ◯ the city's waste problem was getting out of control.
- ◯ there are many problems with the green bin program.

6. Without the green bin program, it's likely that _____

- ◯ regular garbage collection would still be bi-weekly.
- ◯ the mother would purchase a backyard composter.
- ◯ a second garbage dump would need to be built.
- ◯ the gardener would have difficulty finding compost.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	The man is unfamiliar with them.
Question 2	He should consider visiting his doctor.
Question 3	He wants something immediately.
Question 4	He has a new prescription.
Question 5	It's more costly than his previous purchase.
Question 6	
Question 7	He worries about touching his eyes.
Question 8	She knows people benefit from instruction.

PART 2	
Question 1	a customer service clerk
Question 2	A request was granted.
Question 3	to ensure nothing's missing
Question 4	a full reimbursement
Question 5	taken additional costs into account

PART 3	
Question 1	He has an unhealthy tree in his yard.
Question 2	The tree is in a difficult place.
Question 3	that her company is used to small backyards
Question 4	because wood chips from the tree are good for gardens
Question 5	It makes his living room dark.
Question 6	The man will book an appointment this week.

PART 4	
Question 1	was very well known but rare.
Question 2	at a yard sale.
Question 3	by the value of the book.
Question 4	sell the book online.
Question 5	visit a book sale in Germany.

PART 5	
Question 1	work hours
Question 2	a sporting goods retailer
Question 3	to take a short trip
Question 4	Gene is the most experienced supervisor.
Question 5	Gene's lifestyle makes it easier for him.
Question 6	It helps both of them out.
Question 7	accepting
Question 8	They're considerate.

PART 6	
Question 1	the city's composting program is controversial.
Question 2	she has garbage pickup every two weeks.
Question 3	composting with green bins is easier for people.
Question 4	an efficient fix to the city's problem.
Question 5	the green bin program creates something useful.
Question 6	a second garbage dump would need to be built.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman in a pharmacy. The man is asking about eye drops. The pharmacist shows him different types of non-prescription drops.

Section 1:

WOMAN: Good morning. Can I help you?

MAN: I'm having a problem with my eyes. They are red and really itchy and driving me crazy. I'm wondering if you can recommend something.

WOMAN: I can see your eyes look really sore. Have you gone to your doctor?

MAN: No, not yet. I thought I'd get some drops to make the problem go away as quick as possible.

WOMAN: Well, we have over-the-counter eye drops that might help.

MAN: What does over-the-counter mean?

WOMAN: It means that the product doesn't require a prescription. Usually an over-the-counter product is much less expensive, but it can be just as good as the prescription.

MAN: That's what I want. Which eye drops should I get?

WOMAN: Well, this brand is usually effective. But, it depends on what's wrong with your eyes. If you have an infection, for example, you really should see your doctor.

MAN: OK. I'll get these, but if they don't help in a few days, I'll see the doctor.

Now answer questions 1-3.

1. Why does the woman explain about over-the-counter products?
2. What advice did the woman give the man?
3. Why does the man buy over-the-counter eye drops?

Section 2:

MAN: Hi. I was here a few days ago and got some eye drops.

WOMAN: Yes, I remember. Did the drops help?

MAN: Not as much as I hoped, so I took your advice and went to the doctor. He gave me this prescription.

WOMAN: Do you have a health plan that covers your prescriptions?

MAN: No, I don't. So how much will these drops cost?

WOMAN: $30. These are really good eye drops. They should take care of your problem quite quickly.

MAN: Yeah, but $30 is a lot. The other eye drops were only $10 and they made my eyes feel a little better. Why is this prescription so much more expensive?

WOMAN: Well, I think it's just the way pharmaceutical companies set their prices. However, your doctor knows the best medicine to solve your problem, so you can trust that these are excellent eye drops. I'll have them ready for you in ten minutes.

Now answer questions 4-5.

4. Why does the man return to the pharmacy?
5. Why is the man upset about the price?

Transcripts

Section 3:

WOMAN: Your eye drops are ready. Use the drops every day for the next seven days. Put two drops in each eye three times a day. Try to space the time out evenly over the course of the day.

MAN: I can do that, no problem.

WOMAN: The easiest way to get the drops into your eye is to pull out the bottom eyelid and squeeze in the two drops. Then close the eye and rub very gently to move the drops around. Then do the other eye.

MAN: That sounds really hard, but I'll give it a try. I don't like anything getting near my eyes.

WOMAN: You should see a lot of improvement in two or three days. These are really good drops.

MAN: Great. Thanks for your help.

Now answer questions 6-8.

6. Which picture best fits the woman's instructions?
7. Why does the man think the instructions are difficult?
8. Why does the woman tell the man how to use the eye drops?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman at a department store.

WOMAN: Wow, that was quite the lineup for Customer Service. I'd like to return this purchase and get my money back.

MAN: Sorry you had to wait so long. We're short-staffed today, and the manager is off sick. Is there anything wrong with the printer?

WOMAN: No, it's a great machine, and a really good deal too—an all-in-one printer, scanner, copier, and fax for about $90. What's not to like? The thing is, I won't really use it because my son just bought me one exactly like it.

MAN: So it's not needed any more. Okay, our return policy is that we refund the purchase price of returned electronic devices if they're brought back in new condition within 30 days. Do you have your receipt with you?

WOMAN: Right here—sorry, it got a bit crumpled in my wallet. I bought the printer on August 9th, just ten days ago. So it's covered under your return policy, right?

MAN: Let's take a look inside and see. All the original packaging is here . . . the serial number on the printer matches the one on the box . . . you've brought the instruction manual, USB cable, telephone line cord. Where are the ink cartridges?

WOMAN: They're inside the printer. I installed them already. They work just great, and there's still lots of ink in them.

MAN: No worries. We'll take this printer back for you. If you give me your Visa card, I can reimburse you.

WOMAN: I see on the receipt that I was also persuaded to buy a one-year warranty for $10. And there was also some sort of $9 charge called an "Eco-Fee." What's that?

MAN: It's a fee the government collects at all stores, province-wide, to help pay for recycling and safe disposal of electronic items. We'll refund your Eco-Fee as well as the warranty. The $14 in sales tax will also be credited back to your account.

WOMAN: Wow, $90 for the printer . . . plus $33 in warranties, eco-fees, and taxes. That's a lot of hidden fees. Now that I think about it, that purchase wasn't such a bargain after all.

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. Who is the woman talking to?
2. What happened in this conversation?
3. Why does the man open the box?
4. What does the woman get?
5. What should the woman have done differently?

PART 3

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You will hear a conversation where a man gets information about landscaping.

WOMAN: Hi. Welcome to King's Landscaping. What can I do for you?

MAN: Hi there! I'm having a problem with a tree in my backyard. I thought maybe I should ask an expert.

WOMAN: You've come to the right place! Our landscapers have over 20 years of experience. What seems to be the problem?

MAN: I have a very large maple tree, and I think it's rotting. It has fungus growth all over the trunk and it has recently started to bend a little, like it's falling over. It blocks a lot of light to my living room windows anyways, so I thought maybe now is the time to remove it.

WOMAN: Large fungus growth sounds like heart rot disease. That's common in maple trees. It will decay maples from the inside out, often causing a hollow inside. I would recommend getting one of our tree removal experts to come look at it and give you a price estimate.

MAN: That's what I think, too. I have a neighbour who offered to remove it for free, but the tree is very close to a power line, so I don't want any accidents. Also, there might be some difficulty with removing the tree. I live on a steep hillside overlooking a lake, and my backyard is quite small.

WOMAN: I agree with you. Removing trees around power lines can be dangerous and should only be handled by professionals. The space of the property shouldn't be a problem, though. We have several ways that we can remove a tree if there is limited space. We can saw it into many pieces, or if your property is close to the water, we can bring in a boat to haul the tree.

MAN: Oh, great. Now, what about the remaining stump of the tree? The tree is pretty big—I would say the stump is at least 3 feet in diameter.

WOMAN: We grind it down to the ground, and then you can just let lawn grow over it. Are you or any of your neighbours gardeners? We usually leave the wood chips from the stump to place around flowerbeds.

MAN: I'm not, but some of my neighbours are and I'm sure they would love that. Wonderful! Let's book a time this week for someone to come out and take a look.

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. Why did the man call the woman?
2. Why won't the man allow his neighbour to help?
3. Which of the woman's suggestions is the man most pleased with?
4. Why does the woman ask if the man and his neighbours are gardeners?
5. Why is the man happy that the tree will be cut down?
6. What decision do they make at the end of the conversation?

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news item about a surprising book.

Recently, at a neighborhood yard sale, book enthusiast Dale Mackenzie discovered a literary treasure. At the yard sale, Mackenzie bought several books for just $5.00. When he returned home, he noticed that one of the books, an old copy of Emma by the famous English novelist Jane Austen, was a rare first edition of the novel. Curious about the value of the book, Mackenzie looked up an antique book dealer on the internet. "I thought the book might be worth about fifty dollars," said Mackenzie. But, much to his surprise, he found out that a first edition of Emma, like the one he bought at the yard sale, was valued at approximately ten thousand dollars. Mackenzie plans to sell the novel through an internet auction site. He wants to donate half of the profits to the public library—which is in need of a new reading room. "I love books," said Mackenzie, "and would really like to improve our public library so that other booklovers can have a quiet place to go and read." With the remaining money, Mackenzie plans to take a vacation to Germany to visit one of the world's largest annual book fairs.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a conversation among three employees, two men and one woman, in a company's break room. They are discussing an issue at work.

Jake: Hey guys, have you seen next month's schedule? It was posted last night.

Gene: Yeah, and I noticed that I'm scheduled for three weekends in a row. Same thing happened to me last month. I didn't say anything about it because I didn't want to rock the boat, but I really need a weekend off next month.

Jill: That doesn't seem very fair. I wonder what's going on with scheduling.

Jake: Well, maybe it's because most of us and the other supervisors have children and you're single, Gene. I mean, it can be really hard to work weekends when you have family responsibilities. My wife works most weekends—I have to be home.

Jill: But Jake, that's not really fair. I mean, he probably has other responsibilities too. Just because he doesn't have kids doesn't mean he should work almost every weekend.

Jake: Listen, I wouldn't be happy either. Have you talked to the boss about it, Gene?

Gene: Yes, but he said he can't do much about it because it's already been posted. It's up to me to find someone to change with. He also said that because I have the most seniority, he likes to have me there on busy weekends. There's a lot of sports equipment rentals and special orders and stuff, but you guys could totally handle that.

Jill: Yeah, I think any of us could cover the weekends. I actually think it would be good for us to get used to the busy weekend rush. It can't be any busier than the mornings that we get stock. I mean, it took us hours to put away the hockey equipment and the snowboards last Wednesday!

Gene: I wanted to get away for a ski weekend with some friends next month. I wanted test out the downhill skis I bought here last week. Would someone be able to switch shifts with me? I would very happily do two evening shifts in exchange for a weekend shift.

Jake: I'm sorry, Gene. I would if I could, but I have family coming in, visiting next weekend and my wife's working. And my son has a hockey tournament the weekend after that. I actually reserved these weekends off months ago.

Jill: I could switch shifts with you next weekend. Would you be willing to take two day shifts for me at the end of the month, though? My son has a field trip, and my daughter has a school play, and I'd really like to go!

Gene: Oh, thanks a million, Jill! I'll go talk to Mr. Smith right now.

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a presentation about a city compost initiative.

Welcome to Chat Radio. On today's agenda is the topic of green bins: are they a success or a failure? Started two years ago, the green bin program is a waste management strategy implemented to reduce the amount of garbage sent to municipal landfills. As part of the program, individuals are asked to separate their compostable waste, such as food and yard waste, into green bins provided by the city. The bins are collected on a weekly basis and, rather than taken to a landfill, are brought to a facility that turns the waste into compost. Although generally well received, the program has had its share of criticism

For example, for Judith Knightley, a busy mother of three, the green bins are a nightmare. Knightley complains that, not only is it time consuming to sort the copious amount of garbage produced by a large family, but the bins are also unsanitary, attracting both animals and bugs. Although the green bin is not obligatory, since the program began, regular garbage pick-up has been reduced to bi-monthly, leaving many, like Knightly, feeling forced into its use.

In contrast, Kirk Beauregard, an avid gardener, is thrilled with the city's initiative. Beauregard, who, for many years, has composted his own garbage in a backyard composter, is glad to see the city catching up. He insists that composting is an easy way to turn waste into a valuable product, a product used by many farmers and gardeners in place of chemical fertilizers. While Beauregard acknowledges that backyard composting might not be enjoyed by everyone, he sees the green bin program as a way to make the composting of one's own garbage accessible to everyone.

Councillor Trudy Volkov, on the other hand, argues, regardless of like or dislike, that the program was necessary. With the city's rapid population growth, finding an economical way to manage the incredible amount of garbage being produced was essential. According to Volkov, city council was faced with two choices: either build a new landfill, or decrease the amount of waste brought to the current landfill. For Volkov, the green bin is a win-win solution. Not only is the waste diverted from the landfill, but it is converted into a useful product whose sale can help defray some of the costs of running the program.